

Murata Mfg. (6981.T): Visit to Fukui Murata's Takefu Plant: Reaffirmed constant improvement efforts and technological progress; maintain Buy

On 8/18, we had the opportunity to visit Fukui Murata's Takefu Plant. The key points are as follows. **(1) Fukui Murata:** With over 9,000 employees including temporary staff (out of a company-wide total of 74,000), this is Murata's largest site. Within it, the Takefu site comprises 11 buildings in total and is positioned as the mother factory for MLCCs. We toured Building E, the largest on the site, which handles integrated production. **(2) Strengths:** Its three strengths were identified as product variety, delivery times, and quality. The company offers about 50,000 types of MLCCs, an overwhelming number compared with competitors (e.g., 10,000 or 3,000 types). It also employs a job shop production system (in contrast to a flow shop system where products flow in a fixed manner, general-purpose equipment is arranged by process and production follows different routes depending on the product type). This provides strengths in maximizing equipment utilization for each process, enabling flexible production changes (shortening delivery times), and ensuring thorough quality control at each process (improving quality). It has established a unique production system. **(3) Digital Transformation (DX)/Big Data:** Utilizing DX/AI on the big data obtained from this production system, it applies production recipes optimized for each lot to the production floor (variable manufacturing). It is promoting yield improvement, quality standardization, and output improvement from all angles (and has also built a system that allows this to be shared with other sites). For example, it finds optimal production for each lot by adjusting the firing process according to the condition of materials. **(4) In-house equipment:** Almost all the equipment we saw (for sheet forming, electrode forming, stacking, firing, and inspection) was manufactured in-house. **(5) Room for production expansion:** While utilization is at 95% and the company will proceed with capacity expansion as planned, it commented that it also has the capacity to increase output by about 20% (timeline unclear) through self-help efforts such as the aforementioned process and yield improvements, independent of capacity expansion.

We visited this MLCC production site in 2006 (20 years ago), and while the basic manufacturing methods remain the same, this tour gave us a sense of the constant improvement efforts and technological progress that have been made. In MLCCs, all processes are interlinked; it is not a product where improving one single element leads to an overall breakthrough. Rather, it is characterized by a process akin to turning a two-person, three-legged race into a 100-person, 101-legged race, where daily progress across the entire workflow results in increased competitiveness. We were once again reminded that the company's

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strong competitiveness and large production capacity in MLCCs for AI/data center applications are backed by the accumulation of these constant efforts. We have a high regard for the competitiveness and growth potential of the MLCC business and maintain our Buy (CL) rating.

Price Target Risks and Methodology – Murata Mfg.

Valuation methodology: We are Buy-rated on Murata Mfg. with a 12-month price target of ¥12,900. Our target price is based on FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying an 80% premium to our sector multiple of 10X (implies FY3/29E P/E of 30X).

Key risks: Decline in smartphone production volume, deterioration in MLCC supply/demand, and yen appreciation.

6981.T	12m Price Target: ¥12,900	Price: ¥7,483	Upside: 72.4%
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Buy CL		GS Forecast				
Market cap: ¥15.2tr / \$95.2bn Enterprise value: ¥14.4tr / \$90.2bn 3m ADTV: ¥297.6bn / \$1.9bn Japan Japan Electronic Components/Semiconductors M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No			3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
		Revenue (¥ bn)	1,830.9	2,195.8	2,620.0	3,080.0
		Op. profit (¥ bn)	281.8	485.0	700.0	895.0
		Op. profit CoE (¥ bn)	270.0	430.0	–	–
		EPS (¥)	128.5	220.0	328.1	436.3
		P/E (X)	21.5	34.0	22.8	17.2
		P/B (X)	2.0	4.9	4.1	3.4
		Dividend yield (%)	2.4	0.9	1.0	1.1
		N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	(1.4)	(1.1)	(1.1)	(1.2)
		CROCI (%)	13.7	17.8	22.6	26.9
			6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
		EPS (¥)	46.6	57.9	60.4	55.1

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 18 Aug 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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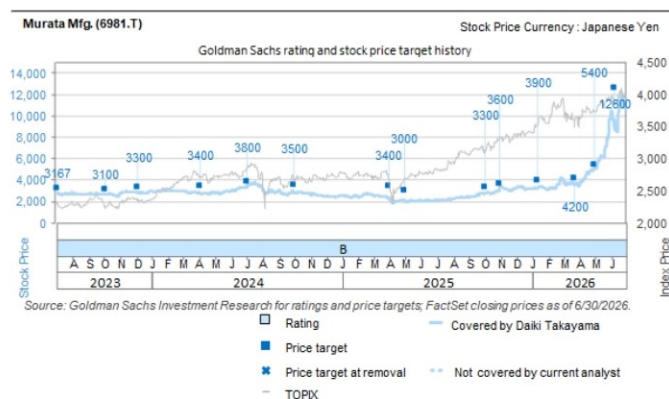
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Target price history table(s)

Murata Mfg. (6981.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
31-Jul-26	12,900	7,416
08-Jun-26	12,600	8,711
30-Apr-26	5,400	5,156
23-Mar-26	4,200	3,508
12-Jan-26	3,900	3,194
31-Oct-25	3,600	3,392
02-Oct-25	3,300	2,770
30-Apr-25	3,000	2,214
31-Mar-25	3,400	2,306
01-Oct-24	3,500	2,893
02-Jul-24	3,800	3,364
03-Apr-24	3,400	2,768
06-Dec-23	3,300	2,892
04-Oct-23	3,100	2,657

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